

PERSONAL READING SERIES

THE CHRISTIAN DENOMINATIONS

What Makes Each Branch Distinct

*From Roman Catholic to Pentecostal. From Mormon to Seventh-day Adventist.
From the oldest institutional Church to the newest megachurch.
What they share. What divides them. Where they agree and disagree
about the most important questions a human being can ask.*

Personal Reading Series • Haligricity • I.Q. Productionz • June 2026

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INTRODUCTION

One Teaching. Two Thousand Years. Forty Thousand Denominations.

There are estimated to be over 45,000 distinct Christian denominations in the world today — each claiming authority to represent the teaching of a first-century Jewish peasant who never wrote anything down. This document does not take sides in the theological disputes between them. It maps them — accurately, fairly, and through the Haligric lens that asks of every tradition the same question: where does this teaching locate divine authority, and does it point that authority inward toward the practitioner's own direct experience, or outward toward an external source?

The answer, across virtually every branch covered here, is the same — outward. The variations are in where outward points: to the Pope, to the Bible, to the charismatic preacher, to the correct doctrinal formula, to the organization. The exceptions — the mystics, the Quakers, certain strands of Pentecostal direct experience — are the places where something more interesting happens. Those exceptions are noted.

ROMAN CATHOLIC

Founded: 1st century CE (as formal institution from 4th century) • Members: ~1.3 billion • HQ: Vatican City

Roman Catholicism is the largest single Christian denomination and the direct institutional descendant of the church that emerged from the Council of Nicaea in 325 CE. The Pope — currently Pope Francis — is understood as the Vicar of Christ on earth: the direct successor of the Apostle Peter, to whom Jesus gave the keys of the Kingdom. Papal infallibility — the teaching that the Pope, when speaking formally on matters of faith and morals, cannot err — was defined as doctrine only in 1870, at the First Vatican Council. It has been formally invoked only twice since. The seven sacraments — Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist, Penance, Anointing of the Sick, Holy Orders, and Matrimony — are the primary mechanisms of divine grace in Catholic theology. The Eucharist is the central sacrament: the bread and wine literally become the body and blood of Jesus Christ through the process of transubstantiation — not symbolically, but actually. The Mass re-presents the sacrifice of Calvary in an unbloody manner, making the grace of that sacrifice available to the congregation. The veneration of Mary and the saints — prayer directed to Mary and to canonized holy persons as intercessors before God — is one of the most distinctive Catholic practices. Mary's specific titles (Theotokos — God-bearer, Co-Redemptrix in some theological currents, Queen of Heaven) preserve a feminine divine presence in Catholic life that is found nowhere else in mainstream Western Christianity. The rosary, the Marian apparitions (Lourdes, Fatima, Guadalupe), and the extraordinary devotion to Mary across Catholic communities globally suggest that the feminine divine, formally excluded from the theology of the Trinity, found her way back through the door of Marian devotion.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS: The Catholic Church is the most complete institutional preservation of pre-Christian Roman religious ritual in the world — Latin, incense, vestments, processional, the liturgical calendar of festivals, the sacred meal, the priestly caste. What Rome absorbed from the indigenous religions it conquered, it preserved inside Christianity. The Haligric practitioner sees both the suppression and the preservation operating simultaneously.**

EASTERN ORTHODOX

Founded: 1st century CE (Great Schism from Rome: 1054 CE) • Members: ~260 million • Centers: Constantinople, Moscow, Alexandria

Eastern Orthodoxy predates the Catholic-Protestant split by 500 years and understands itself as the original and unchanged Christianity — the faith of the apostles transmitted without the innovations that Rome introduced. The Great Schism of 1054 CE formally separated East from West over theological disputes (including the filioque — whether the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father alone or from both Father and Son) and jurisdictional disputes (whether the Pope of Rome had universal authority or was merely first among equals). The theological distinction that makes Orthodoxy the most mystically sophisticated branch of mainstream Christianity is theosis — the teaching that the purpose of human life is not merely forgiveness or moral improvement but actual deification: the human being's progressive transformation into the divine likeness, participating in the divine nature itself. Saint Athanasius's statement — 'God became human so that humans might become God' — is taken with full theological seriousness. This is not metaphor. It is the goal. Orthodox worship is the most complete sensory sacred experience in Christian tradition — the Divine Liturgy (attributed to Saint John Chrysostom) is a two-thousand-year-old ceremony of extraordinary beauty involving chanting, incense, candlelight, iconography, and the progressive movement of the congregation through the drama of creation, fall, and redemption. The icon — the sacred image of Christ, Mary, or the saints — is not a painting but a window into the divine realm, venerated (not worshipped) as a point of contact with the sacred person depicted.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS: Theosis — the teaching that the human being can become divine through participation in the divine energies — is the closest any mainstream Christian tradition has come to the Haligric understanding that the divine lives as the human being. Orthodox mystics like Gregory Palamas and Symeon the New Theologian described experiences of divine light indistinguishable from what Sufi masters, Buddhist meditators, and Hindu yogis describe. The recognition is the same. The vocabulary differs.**

LUTHERAN

Founded: 1517 CE (Martin Luther's Ninety-Five Theses) • Members: ~75 million worldwide

On October 31, 1517, a German Augustinian friar named Martin Luther nailed — or possibly posted — a document containing ninety-five theses for academic debate to the door of the Castle Church in Wittenberg. What Luther intended as an academic disputation became the spark that permanently fractured Western Christianity. Luther's central theological insight — developed from his intensive study of Paul's letter to the Romans — was that salvation is by faith alone (*sola fide*), not by works, not by purchase of indulgences, not by institutional sacramental participation. The righteousness of God that Paul describes is not a demand that the human being must meet but a gift that God gives freely to the person who receives it in faith. This discovery — which Luther described as a 'gateway to paradise' — made the entire sacramental system of the Catholic Church theologically unnecessary. Luther's second principle — *sola scriptura*, scripture alone — removed the Pope's authority as the final interpreter of Christian truth and placed that authority in the biblical text, accessible to any literate person. He translated the Bible into German specifically so that ordinary people could read it for themselves. This was a genuine democratization of religious authority — the first major crack in the wall of institutional mediation — though Luther did not follow its logic to the conclusion that every person's direct interpretation was equally valid.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS: The priesthood of all believers — Luther's teaching that every Christian has direct access to God without institutional mediation — is the most Haligric statement in the Reformation. Luther went to the door of direct access and opened it a crack. He then tried to close it again by insisting on the authority of his specific interpretation of scripture. The door he opened has never fully closed.**

CALVINIST / REFORMED

Founded: 1536 CE (John Calvin, Geneva) • Members: ~80 million (Reformed churches globally)

John Calvin was a French theologian who made Geneva, Switzerland into a model Protestant city in the mid-sixteenth century. His theology went further than Luther's in its logical rigor and in its most controversial doctrine: predestination. Calvin argued, from Paul and from Augustine, that God — being omniscient and omnipotent — has determined from eternity who will be saved (the elect) and who will be damned (the reprobate). This determination is not based on God's foreknowledge of the individual's choices but on God's sovereign will alone. Nothing the individual does can change it. The elect will believe; the reprobate will not. Grace is irresistible to those chosen to receive it. The psychological consequences of this doctrine were profound. Max Weber, in *The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism*, argued that the anxiety produced by not knowing whether one was among the elect produced a compensatory drive toward worldly success — which was then read as a sign of election. The accumulation of wealth as evidence of divine favor is the theological root of the prosperity gospel that Joel Osteen preaches today, though the connection has been largely forgotten.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS: Predestination is the logical endpoint of a theology that places all divine authority outside the human being — if God determines everything and the human being determines nothing, the human being is simply a passive recipient of a divine decision made before they were born. No Haligric tradition anywhere in the world operates from this framework. Every tradition in this library, without exception, teaches that the human being is a conscious participant in their own becoming.**

ANGLICAN / EPISCOPALIAN

Founded: 1534 CE (Henry VIII's Act of Supremacy) • Members: ~85 million (Anglican Communion globally)

The Church of England was not born from theological conviction. It was born from a divorce. When Pope Clement VII refused to annul Henry VIII's marriage to Catherine of Aragon — partly because Catherine's nephew, the Holy Roman Emperor Charles V, had the Pope essentially under political control — Henry had Parliament pass the Act of Supremacy in 1534, declaring the English monarch the Supreme Head of the Church in England. What began as a political maneuver gradually developed a theological identity. Archbishop Thomas Cranmer developed the Book of Common Prayer — first issued in 1549 — which gave English Christianity its characteristic liturgical language, resonant and poetic in a way that influenced English literature as profoundly as Shakespeare. The *via media* — the middle way between Catholic sacramentalism and Protestant doctrinal rigidity — became Anglicanism's theological identity: Catholic in structure, Protestant in doctrine, with considerable room for both within its broad tent. The Episcopal Church in the United States is the American branch of the Anglican Communion — formed after the American Revolution when American Anglicans could no longer swear allegiance to the British crown. It has been one of the most theologically progressive major denominations in American Christianity — ordaining women as priests in 1976, ordaining openly gay bishops, and conducting same-sex marriages.

◆ **HALIGRIC LENS:** The Anglican tradition's greatest contribution is its liturgical language — the Book of Common Prayer gave English speakers a vocabulary for the sacred that has shaped poetry, literature, and personal prayer for five centuries. The Haligric practitioner recognizes that beauty in sacred language is not decorative but functional — it opens the resonant body in a way that doctrinal propositions cannot.

METHODIST

Founded: 1739 CE (John Wesley, England) • Members: ~80 million worldwide

John Wesley was an Anglican priest who never intended to found a new denomination. He began leading small groups — called Holy Clubs, and mockingly nicknamed Methodists for their methodical approach to spiritual discipline — within the Church of England. In 1739, at a small meeting on Aldersgate Street in London, he had an experience he described in his journal: 'I felt my heart strangely warmed. I felt I did trust in Christ, Christ alone for salvation; and an assurance was given me that He had taken away my sins, even mine, and saved me from the law of sin and death.' This direct personal experience of divine presence — not mediated by sacrament, not produced by correct doctrine, but felt as a warmth in the heart — became the model for Methodist spirituality. Wesley traveled 250,000 miles on horseback and preached 40,000 sermons across Britain and America, bringing the experience of conversion to people who had never felt it within the established church. Methodist theology emphasizes prevenient grace (God's grace available to everyone before any human response), free will (rejecting Calvinist predestination), social holiness (personal transformation expressed through social justice), and the possibility of entire sanctification — the Wesleyan teaching that the believer can, in this life, reach a state in which love of God and neighbor perfectly governs all action.

❖ **HALIGRIC LENS: Wesley's heart strangely warmed is a direct felt experience of the divine — the kind of experience that the Haligric framework calls recognition. The Methodist tradition at its best is the tradition that says: the experience is real, the feeling is valid, direct encounter with the sacred is available to every person. It is the closest the Protestant tradition came to validating the felt, bodily, direct experience of the divine.**

BAPTIST

Founded: 1609 CE (John Smyth, Amsterdam) • Members: ~100 million worldwide

Baptists emerged from the Radical Reformation — the wing of the Protestant movement that believed Luther and Calvin had not gone far enough in reforming the church. The defining Baptist distinctive is believer's baptism: only persons who have made a conscious, adult profession of faith should be baptized, and baptism should be by full immersion, not sprinkling. Infant baptism — practiced by Catholics, Lutherans, Anglicans, and Presbyterians — is rejected as theologically meaningless: an infant cannot make the conscious choice that baptism is meant to symbolize. Baptist theology emphasizes soul competency — every individual has the right and responsibility to interpret scripture for themselves, without ecclesiastical authority. Local church autonomy means that each Baptist congregation is self-governing and answerable to no external authority — no bishop, no denomination, no Pope. Separation of church and state — which Baptists championed in colonial America partly from their own experience of persecution by established churches — was the Baptist contribution to the First Amendment of the United States Constitution. The Southern Baptist Convention, formed in 1845 in part over the question of whether slaveholders could be appointed as missionaries, is the largest Protestant denomination in America with approximately 14 million members. It formally apologized for its support of slavery and racism in 1995.

◆ **HALIGRIC LENS:** Soul competency — the Baptist teaching that every individual has direct access to God and direct responsibility for their own interpretation of divine truth — is the most democratically Haligric doctrine in the Protestant tradition. The tragedy is that Baptist communities have often enforced cultural and theological conformity with the same intensity as the institutions their founders fled, subordinating the principle of soul competency to the pressure of community conformity.

PENTECOSTAL

Founded: 1906 CE (Azusa Street Revival, Los Angeles) • Members: ~600 million worldwide

On April 9, 1906, in a former African Methodist Episcopal church on Azusa Street in Los Angeles, a Black Holiness preacher named William Joseph Seymour led a prayer meeting at which participants began speaking in tongues — an experience they identified as the baptism of the Holy Spirit identical to the experience described in the second chapter of the Acts of the Apostles. Word spread rapidly. The Azusa Street Revival continued for three years with services morning, afternoon, and night, drawing visitors from around the world who experienced healings, prophecy, speaking in tongues, and what they described as the direct felt presence of the divine. Pentecostalism is now the fastest-growing form of Christianity in the world — with approximately 600 million adherents globally, concentrated particularly in sub-Saharan Africa, Latin America, and Southeast Asia. Its distinctive practices — glossolalia (speaking in tongues), divine healing, prophecy, and worship characterized by emotional expressiveness — represent a recovery of the experiential dimension of sacred life that institutional Christianity had progressively suppressed. The Charismatic movement brought Pentecostal experience into mainline Protestant and Catholic churches from the 1960s onward, producing Catholic Charismatics who speak in tongues while remaining fully Catholic and attending Mass — a synthesis that would have been theologically incomprehensible a century ago.

◆ **HALIGRIC LENS: The Pentecostal tradition's insistence on direct felt experience of the divine — that the sacred can be felt in the body, heard as language, expressed through movement and sound — is the most Haligric impulse in contemporary Christianity. The speaking in tongues, the healing prayer, the prophecy — these are the closest that mainstream Christianity has come to what the Yoruba tradition calls Ashe moving through the body, what the Aboriginal tradition calls being moved by the Dreaming, what the shamanic tradition calls spirit speaking through the practitioner.**

EVANGELICAL

A theological orientation, not a single denomination • ~660 million adherents globally • ~25% of Americans

Evangelicalism is not a denomination but a theological family that cuts across multiple denominations — Baptist, Methodist, Presbyterian, non-denominational, and Pentecostal congregations can all be Evangelical. The four defining characteristics, identified by historian David Bebbington as the 'Bebbington Quadrilateral,' are: Biblicism (the Bible as the supreme authority for faith and practice), Crucicentrism (the atoning death of Christ as the central event of Christian faith), Conversionism (the necessity of personal transformation through a conscious conversion experience — being 'born again'), and Activism (the obligation to share the faith through evangelism and social action). The born-again experience — which can be a dramatic moment or a gradual process — is understood as the threshold crossing between the old life and the new: the moment when the individual consciously receives Christ as their personal savior and is spiritually regenerated. This experience is the Evangelical equivalent of initiation — the moment that separates the person who has not yet crossed from the person who has.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS:** The born-again threshold is a genuine recognition of discontinuity — the moment when the person is not who they were before. Every initiatory tradition in the Haligrity library marks the same crossing: the sweat lodge, the ayahuasca ceremony, the Eleusinian Mysteries, the shamanic illness and recovery. The Evangelical tradition identified the crossing accurately. What it did with the person after the crossing — directing their transformed awareness toward an external savior rather than toward the recognition of the divine within — is where the tradition diverged from its own deepest intuition.

NON-DENOMINATIONAL / MEGACHURCH

Emerged: late 20th century • Lakewood Church (Houston): 45,000 weekly • Fastest-growing church model in America

The non-denominational megachurch is the dominant form of American Protestant Christianity in the early 21st century — large congregations, typically meeting in repurposed arenas or purpose-built facilities with theater seating, professional production, contemporary music indistinguishable from popular music, and a charismatic senior pastor whose personal brand is often more recognizable than the church's name. Joel Osteen's Lakewood Church in Houston — which you are geographically close to — is the largest congregation in America, meeting in the former Compaq Center arena. Osteen's prosperity gospel teaching — that God wants believers to be financially wealthy, that positive confession and faith produce material abundance, that poverty is a sign of insufficient faith — is the most widely broadcast theological message in contemporary American Christianity. The prosperity gospel has roots in New Thought — in the Law of Attraction, in the power of spoken affirmation, in the teaching that consciousness shapes material reality. It is New Thought repackaged in Evangelical Christian language, with one crucial addition: the tithing requirement that directs a portion of whatever abundance the believer receives toward the ministry that taught them to receive it.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS:** The prosperity gospel identified something real — the creative power of spoken intention, the relationship between inner state and outer circumstance — and placed it in a framework that extracted money, externalized divine authority to charismatic leaders, and left practitioners blaming their own insufficient faith when results didn't come. The mechanism is real. The theology surrounding it distorts it. Haligrity holds the mechanism without the extraction.

SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTIST

Founded: 1863 CE • Members: ~22 million worldwide • Known for: health, longevity, Blue Zone communities

Seventh-day Adventists observe the Sabbath on Saturday — the seventh day as specified in the Hebrew scriptures — not Sunday, which they understand as a later Catholic innovation. They believe in the imminent second coming of Christ, the unconscious state of the dead until resurrection (soul sleep), and the investigative judgment — a specific Adventist doctrine that Christ has been engaged since 1844 in a heavenly investigation of the records of the dead. Ellen G. White, one of the church's founders, was a prolific visionary and writer whose health reform vision — received in the 1860s, decades before germ theory was established — anticipated much of modern nutritional science. She advocated for vegetarian diet, abstinence from alcohol and tobacco, fresh air, sunlight, exercise, and adequate rest as health principles with spiritual foundations. The Loma Linda, California Adventist community is one of only five global Blue Zones — geographic areas identified by researchers Dan Buettner and Michel Poulain where people live measurably longer and healthier lives than average. Loma Linda Adventists live approximately 10 years longer than their California neighbors, attributed to their plant-based diet, community cohesion, regular Sabbath rest, and avoidance of alcohol and tobacco.

◆ **HALIGRIC LENS: The Seventh-day Adventist community is one of the most compelling modern examples of sacred practice directly producing measurable physical health outcomes. The Haligric understanding that body care is sacred practice — that the body is a divine instrument that responds to intentional tending — is proven by Loma Linda's longevity data. The Sabbath rest as a weekly sacred practice of complete renewal is one of the most Haligric teachings in the Christian tradition.**

MORMON / LATTER-DAY SAINTS (LDS)

Founded: 1830 CE (Joseph Smith, Upstate New York) • Members: ~17 million worldwide

Joseph Smith founded the Church of Christ — later the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints — in 1830 in Upstate New York, claiming to have received golden plates from the angel Moroni containing the history of ancient peoples in the Americas who had received a visit from the resurrected Christ. The Book of Mormon, which Smith translated 'by the gift and power of God,' became the scripture of the new church. LDS theology is among the most original religious systems produced on American soil. God the Father has a physical, glorified body of flesh and bones. Human souls existed as spirit children of Heavenly Father and Heavenly Mother in a pre-mortal existence before birth. Earth life is a test — a necessary experience in physical bodies that the spirit children of God could not have without coming to earth. After death, the faithful progress through degrees of glory and, at the highest Celestial level, can become gods themselves — presiding over their own worlds and spirit children in an eternal progression. Heavenly Mother is among the most significant and most suppressed figures in American religious history. LDS theology explicitly teaches that God has a wife — that all human beings are spirit children of both a Heavenly Father and a Heavenly Mother. She is almost never discussed in official LDS settings.

◆ **HALIGRIC LENS:** The LDS teaching that human beings can become gods — that eternal progression leads to divinity — arrives at the same destination as Advaita Vedanta (Atman is Brahman), as Orthodox Christian theosis, as the Yoruba understanding of the Ori's divine destiny, through a completely different route and in a completely different theological framework. The Heavenly Mother — present in the theology, actively silenced in practice — is the divine feminine suppressed inside the tradition that acknowledges her existence.

JEHOVAH'S WITNESSES

Founded: 1870s CE (Charles Taze Russell) • Members: ~8.7 million active publishers worldwide

Charles Taze Russell founded what became the Jehovah's Witnesses in the 1870s in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, beginning as a Bible study group and developing into a distinct organization under the Watch Tower Bible and Tract Society. The name Jehovah's Witnesses was adopted in 1931 under Russell's successor, Joseph Franklin Rutherford. Distinctive Witness theology diverges from mainstream Christianity at several critical points. Jesus Christ is not God but the first and greatest of God's creations — the Archangel Michael in spiritual form, elevated to divine status at his resurrection. The Holy Spirit is not a person of the Trinity but God's active force. The 144,000 mentioned in Revelation are the anointed class who will rule with Christ in heaven; the remainder of the faithful will live in paradise on a restored earth after Armageddon. Blood transfusions are prohibited — blood is sacred and the prohibition on eating blood in the Hebrew scriptures is interpreted as prohibiting the introduction of blood from another person into one's own body. Birthdays and holidays (including Christmas and Easter) are not celebrated — they are identified as having pagan origins. The door-to-door ministry is not merely an outreach activity but a theological obligation — Witnesses are 'publishers' of God's Kingdom, and the hours spent in door-to-door work are recorded and submitted monthly to the congregation.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS:** The Witness community structure is one of the most complete examples of institutional control of personal spiritual authority in contemporary religion. Disfellowshipping — formal expulsion from the community for violations of Witness doctrine or morality — results in complete shunning by all other Witnesses, including family members. The threat of losing all one's community relationships is a powerful mechanism of compliance. The Haligric practitioner recognizes this as the institutional form of the dynamic Jesus himself confronted in the Temple priesthood — a religious authority that controls access to the sacred and extracts compliance as the price.

CHRISTIAN SCIENCE

Founded: 1879 CE (Mary Baker Eddy) • Members: ~100,000 (declining) • The Christian Science Monitor: internationally respected journalism

Mary Baker Eddy founded the Church of Christ, Scientist in 1879 after a healing experience she attributed to her reading of the New Testament account of Jesus healing a paralytic. Her book *Science and Health with Key to the Scriptures* (1875) presents her theological system: matter is not ultimately real; God is the only reality; sin, sickness, and death are illusions — products of incorrect thinking — and healing comes through the correction of thought to align with divine truth. Christian Scientists do not use medical treatment or medication. Healing is sought through prayer — specifically through Christian Science practitioners, trained healers who pray for those who are ill. Legal cases involving the death of children whose parents refused medical treatment on religious grounds have created ongoing legal and ethical controversy. The *Christian Science Monitor* — the church's newspaper, founded in 1908 — is one of the most respected and balanced journalism outlets in the world, winning multiple Pulitzer Prizes and known internationally for its even-handed reporting on complex global issues.

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS:** Christian Science identified something real — the relationship between mental state and physical health, the capacity of consciousness to affect the body — and took it further than evidence supports in rejecting medical care entirely. New Thought, which emerged from the same late-19th century New England context, made a more nuanced version of the same insight without the medical rejection. Haligrity holds the insight — that consciousness, prayer, and intention affect physical wellbeing — while embracing the body's own intelligence and the gifts of both traditional medicine and sacred healing practice.

THE HALIGRIC MAP

Where Each Branch Stands on the Central Question

The central Haligric question — where does this tradition locate divine authority, and does it point that authority inward or outward? — produces a clear map when applied to the traditions covered in this document.

TRADITION	DIVINE AUTHORITY LOCATED IN	DIRECT ACCESS?
Roman Catholic	Pope, Sacraments, Institution	Limited — through Church
Eastern Orthodox	Holy Tradition, Theosis	Yes — through theosis
Lutheran	Scripture alone	Partial — faith alone
Calvinist	God's sovereign decree	No — predestined
Anglican	Scripture, Tradition, Reason	Partial — broad tent
Methodist	Personal experience + Scripture	Yes — heart warmed
Baptist	Scripture + Soul Competency	Yes — direct Bible access
Pentecostal	Holy Spirit experience	Yes — felt directly
Evangelical	Scripture + Conversion	Partial — born again
Megachurch/Prosperity	Pastor + Faith declarations	Mediated — through leader
Seventh-day Adventist	Scripture + Ellen White	Partial — structured
Mormon/LDS	Restored Church, Living Prophet	Mediated — through structure
Jehovah's Witnesses	Watch Tower Society	No — Organization interprets
Christian Science	Correct understanding of Truth	Yes — direct Mind

♦ **HALIGRIC LENS:** The map shows clearly that direct access to the divine — the Haligric teaching that every person is already in relationship with the sacred and requires no intermediary — appears most strongly in Pentecostal experience, Methodist heart-knowledge, Baptist soul competency, Orthodox theosis, and Christian Science's direct Mind. These are the strands within Christianity that came closest to what Haligricity teaches. They are the allies within the tradition — the places where the original teaching survived the institution that tried to replace it.

